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Reflective Practice

It is time for you to reflect on your learning throughout this work term preparation course.

Answer the following three (3) questions with a minimum of 200 words for each question:

1. What have you learned throughout this work-term preparation course and how has it shaped or changed your career path?

Throughout this work-term preparation course I've learnt a lot about interviews, marketing ourselves and how to seek a co-op. Before this course, I didn't know how to make a proper or even decent resume but now, I'm more confident in my ability to make well designed and informative resumes. It's the same with cover-letters, I didn't even know what one was before this course but now, I'm not only knowledgeable about them but can make them myself. Furthermore, allowing us to practice interviews with InStage has allowed me to understand more about how the actual interview may be and given me more insights into how to improve my speech. Then there's seeking a co-op. I learnt about the proper procedures that come into seeking a cooperative position and what I should be looking for as well as how to avoid fraudulent positions. I also got to learn how to better and more easily connect with others. I didn't even have a LinkedIn before this but now, I have a proper LinkedIn and have some connections! I've learnt how to make more connections and how to connect with others. Also, I've learnt the usefulness and power of having connections. We got to learn examples of students who managed to get positions and internships just being connected to the right people.

2. What career goals do you have for the future and what steps will you take to achieve them during your work-term?

For me personally, right now I was thinking about starting with Web Development or QA testing and then moving more into Data science or Embedded programming down the line. During my work term, I'll actively try to build out as many connections as possible whilst having friendly connection with my fellow colleagues. Whilst this, I would also ask them about the industry and try, to the best of my abilities, to learn more about not only their connections but also learn more from them. Learning from people who are already in the industry is an amazing way to help build connections and gain valuable insight about the industry and how to advance. I would ask my colleagues about recommendations for anything industry related as their inputs would have a large amount of value as they're already in the industry. Whilst this, I would also try in my free time to reach out to others in related fields that I desire and ask them questions, get to know them and learn more about the industry and related topics. Overall, I would like to go into web or quality assurance testing right now and move more into data science or embedded and during my work term, I would build connections with both my fellow colleagues and outsiders as to try to learn more about not only the industry but to build more connections.

3. What competencies and skills have you mastered throughout your educational and work experience and how will you use it to your advantage in the work-term?

The most important skills I have mastered and learnt throughout my educational career and work experience would have to be problem solving, working as a team and organization. Firstly, problem solving, I have learnt how to tackle and break down problems into smaller, more understandable and manageable subsets that I can easily handle. For example, when working on my mobile application for an assignment, I was able to break down the general task of building an event application into smaller bits and pieces. For example, I broke down that I needed a page for handling registrations, one for logging in, one for viewing events, etc. I was able to break down the general idea of an event viewing application' into smaller and easier tasks. Then I have teamwork, I have been able to consistently lead group members, equally distribute tasks and ensure consistency among each other. For instance, when working on one of our group workshops for the Software Project Management course, I would start out by sending a message that details the task in simple terms and helping my group mates choose specific tasks they were comfortable, understood and enjoyed doing. Furthermore, I have learnt how to ask questions to my colleagues. This has allowed me to easily clear up any miscommunication between us or even just clarify any concepts. Finally, I learnt organizational skills. I have learnt how to organize not only my workspace but also organize information in an easy to read and follow

format. I have specific folders and locations for each of my courses and use Notion to keep better track of my notes and organize my information. Therefore, I would use these skills to my advantage in my work-term by being able to break down any problems given to me into my understandable and smaller tasks, able to ask questions and better keep track of any important information.